

Judge Pauses Border Wall Work in Texas' Big Bend Region

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A federal judge in Texas **temporarily** stopped the Trump administration from building a border wall and other structures across the Big Bend region. The ruling came on Friday. It pauses construction while the court considers the legal case.

The order covers Big Bend National Park and the whole Big Bend border **sector**. A **sector** is a section of the border. This one is about 500 miles long, roughly a quarter of the southern border with Mexico. The park sits on a bend of the Rio Grande River.

The projects are part of a \$46 billion border plan. That plan includes steel walls, vehicle barriers, roads and **surveillance** technology. **Surveillance** means watching an area to gather information.

Landowners, businesses and environmentalists oppose the projects. Opponents say the remote, **rugged** land already discourages people from crossing the border illegally. They also argue that the government wrongly skipped rules meant to protect the environment, culture and archaeological sites.

Judge Kathleen Cardone said the people bringing the case were likely to win at least one **claim**. She also said they could suffer serious harm that could not be undone without a court order.

The first wall panels went up in the **sector** in mid-September. After bulldozers cleared land in the park in August, both Republicans and Democrats called for work to stop. A government pause there ended on September 30.

The administration says it is reviewing plans for the park. Park **advocates** want it to repair damage, meet with local residents and develop other plans.

Word Treasure

temporarily -- For a limited time.

sector -- A section of a larger area.

surveillance -- Watching an area to gather information.

rugged -- Rough and uneven.

claim -- An argument someone asks a court to consider.

advocates -- People who speak up for something they support.

Background you need

The article uses sector to mean a section of the border.

Surveillance means watching an area to gather information.

Break it down

Opens with the judge's temporary construction pause.

Explains the area covered and the planned projects.

Describes opponents' arguments and the judge's reasoning.

Ends with earlier construction, the government's review and advocates' requests.

Why it matters

The ruling affects construction in a national park and the surrounding border region. The case concerns government projects and rules meant to protect important places.

Test what you remember

1. What did the judge's ruling do?
 - (A) Moved construction to another state
 - (B) Temporarily stopped border construction
 - (C) Approved every planned border project
 - (D) Permanently closed the national park
2. Which area does the court order cover?
 - (A) Only roads outside the park
 - (B) Every national park in Texas
 - (C) The entire border with Mexico
 - (D) The whole Big Bend border sector
3. Which river bends beside Big Bend National Park?
 - (A) The Rio Grande River
 - (B) The Mississippi River
 - (C) The Missouri River
 - (D) The Colorado River
4. What do opponents say about the region's rugged land?
 - (A) It prevents all river travel
 - (B) It makes construction much easier
 - (C) It discourages illegal border crossings
 - (D) It needs more roads for visitors
5. When did the first wall panels go up in the sector?
 - (A) At the end of September
 - (B) At the beginning of August
 - (C) In the middle of September
 - (D) At the beginning of October
6. What do park advocates want the government to do?
 - (A) Expand walls and postpone local meetings
 - (B) Build roads and end its review
 - (C) Close trails and cancel other plans
 - (D) Repair damage and meet local residents

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: C 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Judge Kathleen Cardone: She said the people bringing the case were likely to win at least one claim and could face harm that could not be undone without a court order.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):